

DOC 1 — QUESTIONS: Inference / Complete-the-Text (80 MCQs)

EASY (Q1-Q16)

Q1. [Easy]

Certain species of fireflies synchronize their flashing patterns so that thousands of individuals blink in unison across a forest canopy. Biologist Maren Otsuka has proposed that this synchronization evolved as a means of reducing visual clutter: when all members of a species flash at the same moment, their signals are easier to distinguish from those of other species flashing at different intervals. If Otsuka's proposal is correct, synchronized flashing would primarily benefit fireflies in habitats where ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) the total number of firefly individuals is declining due to habitat loss. B) ambient light from human development interferes with mating displays. C) predators rely on bioluminescent signals to locate prey at night. D) multiple firefly species coexist and produce overlapping light signals.
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Q2. [Easy]

Economists have long measured national prosperity primarily through gross domestic product (GDP), which captures the total monetary value of goods and services a country produces. However, some researchers argue that GDP alone provides an incomplete picture, since it does not account for factors such as income inequality, environmental degradation, or citizens' subjective sense of fulfillment. These researchers therefore suggest that GDP ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) is a useful but insufficient indicator that should be supplemented with additional measures of well-being. B) should be replaced with a metric that focuses exclusively on environmental sustainability. C) was originally designed to measure individual happiness rather than aggregate economic output. D) has become increasingly accurate as data collection methods have improved over time.
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Q3. [Easy]

Archaeologist Priya Sharma examined pottery fragments unearthed at a trading settlement along the ancient Silk Road. The chemical composition of the clay matched deposits found only near kilns in central China, yet the decorative motifs on the fragments resembled artistic traditions common in Persia during the same period. Sharma concluded that the pottery was most likely manufactured in China and then ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) decorated with Persian-influenced designs before being shipped westward for trade. B) buried by local artisans who had no knowledge of Chinese ceramic techniques. C) produced using a formula that Persian merchants had originally developed. D) exported exclusively to markets within China's own borders.
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Q4. [Easy]

The axolotl, a salamander native to Lake Xochimilco in Mexico, retains its larval features throughout adulthood—a phenomenon known as neoteny. Unlike most amphibians, which undergo metamorphosis and transition to a terrestrial lifestyle, the axolotl remains fully aquatic, breathing through feathery external gills. Scientists believe this trait persisted because Lake Xochimilco's stable, resource-rich waters offered little advantage for a shift to land. This explanation implies that neoteny in the axolotl is best understood as ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) a temporary developmental stage that most axolotls eventually outgrow under laboratory conditions. B) evidence that all salamander species are capable of remaining aquatic if resources are abundant. C) an adaptation shaped by the specific environmental conditions of the species' native habitat. D) a disadvantage that limits the axolotl's ability to colonize new ecosystems.

Q5. [Easy]

Psychologist Elena Voss conducted a study in which participants were asked to evaluate the creativity of two nearly identical paintings. One painting was attributed to a well-known artist, while the other was attributed to an unknown art student. Participants consistently rated the painting attributed to the famous artist as more creative, even though the two paintings differed only in their attributed authorship.

What does the text most strongly imply about the participants' evaluations?

A) Participants lacked the training necessary to distinguish genuinely creative work from ordinary work. B) Participants' assessments were shaped more by the perceived reputation of the creator than by the artwork itself. C) Participants preferred traditional artistic styles over experimental ones regardless of authorship. D) Participants found the paintings too similar to evaluate and therefore guessed at random.

Q6. [Easy]

The mineral olivine is abundant in Earth's upper mantle but relatively uncommon on the planet's surface because it weathers rapidly when exposed to water and atmospheric carbon dioxide. Geologist David Henriksen noted that large surface deposits of olivine persist in certain arid regions of Oman, where rainfall is minimal and temperatures are extreme. Henriksen's observation most strongly implies that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the olivine in Oman originally formed on the planet's surface rather than in the mantle. B) the olivine found in Oman has a different chemical composition from olivine found in the mantle. C) olivine deposits are equally common on the surfaces of all desert environments worldwide. D) the arid climate in those regions has slowed the chemical weathering process that would normally break down olivine.

Q7. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from a 1913 novel by Mitsuko Abe. The narrator, Haruki, has just returned to his childhood village after many years abroad.

The village had shrunk. Not in any literal, measurable way—the hills still crouched at the same distances, and the creek still carved its old path behind the schoolhouse. But the buildings seemed to huddle closer together now, as though bracing against something invisible, and the streets that had once felt like vast avenues to a boy of seven could be crossed in a handful of adult strides. Haruki paused at the bridge and understood: nothing here had changed but himself.

As presented in the text, Haruki would most likely agree with which statement?

A) The village has deteriorated significantly since he left and is in need of restoration. B) The village deliberately reduced the width of its streets to discourage outside visitors. C) His perception of the village's size has changed because he himself has grown and gained broader experience. D) His memories of the village were unreliable because he was too young to form accurate impressions.

Q8. [Easy]

Astronomers have observed that certain exoplanets orbiting red dwarf stars are tidally locked, meaning one hemisphere permanently faces the star while the other remains in perpetual darkness. Some researchers have speculated that such planets could still harbor liquid water if atmospheric circulation were strong enough to distribute heat from the illuminated side to the dark side. This speculation implies that the habitability of tidally

locked planets depends in part on ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) whether the planet's atmosphere can effectively transfer thermal energy across its surface. B) how far the planet is from other stars in its galactic neighborhood. C) whether the planet has a solid metallic core similar to Earth's. D) how quickly the planet completes one full rotation on its axis.

Q9. [Easy]

A school district implemented a new reading program that paired struggling fourth-grade readers with trained volunteer tutors for three weekly thirty-minute sessions. After one academic year, students in the program showed an average improvement of 1.4 grade levels in reading proficiency, compared to an improvement of 0.6 grade levels among students who did not participate. However, participation was voluntary, and students who enrolled were those whose parents had actively sought additional support. The study's design therefore makes it difficult to determine whether ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the volunteer tutors had adequate training to work with fourth-grade students. B) the observed improvement resulted from the tutoring program itself or from the heightened parental involvement that led to enrollment. C) reading proficiency is an important predictor of academic success in later grades. D) the district should expand the program to include students in other grade levels.

Q10. [Easy]

During the late nineteenth century, Japan's Meiji government invested heavily in railroad construction, connecting major cities and ports that had previously been linked only by footpaths and horse-drawn carts. Historians have noted that these railroads did more than accelerate the movement of goods; they also facilitated the rapid spread of newspapers and standardized educational materials to rural areas.

What does the text most strongly imply about the effects of railroad expansion in Meiji-era Japan?

A) The railroads primarily benefited urban manufacturers at the expense of rural agricultural communities. B) Rural communities resisted the introduction of standardized educational materials. C) The government constructed railroads mainly to prepare for potential military conflicts. D) The railroads helped unify the country culturally and intellectually, not just economically.

Q11. [Easy]

Chemist Lina Ferreira studied a class of synthetic polymers designed to break down in seawater within six months. In laboratory tanks simulating ocean conditions, the polymers degraded on schedule. However, when Ferreira tested the same polymers in actual coastal waters, degradation took nearly fourteen months. Ferreira attributed the discrepancy to the laboratory simulations' failure to replicate certain variables present in natural marine environments, such as fluctuating temperatures and microbial competition.

As presented in the text, Ferreira would most likely agree with which statement about the polymer degradation study?

A) The polymers are fundamentally unsuitable for use in marine applications. B) The polymers degraded faster in natural seawater because of the presence of additional microbial activity. C) Laboratory simulations, while useful, may not fully capture the complexity of real-world ocean conditions. D) Future laboratory simulations should use freshwater rather than artificial seawater for greater accuracy.

Q12. [Easy]

Art historian Tomás Reyes has argued that the widespread adoption of oil paint in fifteenth-century Europe did not merely offer artists a new medium—it fundamentally altered the kinds of subjects they chose to depict. Because oil paint dried slowly and could be layered to produce subtle gradations of light and shadow, artists

could render textures like velvet, glass, and human skin with unprecedented realism. This capability, Reyes contends, encouraged painters to focus increasingly on secular subjects, such as portraits and domestic scenes, where the display of material detail was _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) less important than conveying religious symbolism. B) a central artistic objective. C) discouraged by the artistic academies of the period. D) impossible to achieve without the use of tempera.

Q13. [Easy]

Sociologist Karen Whitfield found that in a survey of 2,000 urban commuters, those who reported walking or cycling to work also reported higher levels of daily energy and lower levels of stress compared to those who commuted by car. Whitfield cautioned, however, that the survey measured correlation rather than causation. Some critics have noted that the active commuters in the survey tended to live in neighborhoods with lower crime rates, shorter commute distances, and more green space.

Which statement, if true, would most directly support the critics' concern about Whitfield's findings?

A) Commuters who live in neighborhoods with abundant green space report higher well-being regardless of how they commute. B) Walking and cycling release endorphins that have been scientifically linked to improved mood and reduced stress. C) The survey's sample size was large enough to produce statistically significant results. D) Several participants in the survey switched from car commuting to cycling during the study period.

Q14. [Easy]

Sound travels faster through water than through air because water molecules are packed more closely together, allowing vibrations to transfer more efficiently from one molecule to the next. Engineers designing underwater communication systems exploit this property by using acoustic signals rather than radio waves, which are rapidly absorbed by seawater. The choice to use acoustic signals in underwater systems therefore reflects the fact that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) radio waves travel at the same speed in water as they do in air. B) sound waves cannot travel through substances denser than water. C) acoustic signals are easier for marine animals to detect than radio waves. D) the physical properties of water make it a more effective medium for transmitting sound than for transmitting radio signals.

Q15. [Easy]

The following text is adapted from a 1927 short story by Esme Caldwell. The narrator describes her grandmother's garden.

My grandmother tended her roses the way a conductor leads an orchestra—not through force, but through an exquisite attention that summoned each bloom into its fullest expression. She never explained what she was doing or why; I simply understood, watching her hands move among the thorns without hesitation, that expertise could look indistinguishable from tenderness.

What does the text most strongly imply about the narrator's view of her grandmother?

A) The narrator admires her grandmother's gardening skill but wishes she would share her techniques. B) The narrator sees her grandmother's practiced expertise as graceful and intuitive rather than mechanical. C) The narrator believes her grandmother's gardening abilities have declined with age. D) The narrator considers her grandmother's reluctance to explain her methods to be a form of selfishness.

Q16. [Easy]

In the fifteenth century, the city of Timbuktu in present-day Mali served as a center of Islamic scholarship and trade. The city's Sankoré Mosque housed one of the largest libraries in the medieval world, with collections that

rivaled those of contemporary European institutions. Despite the library's significance, many of its manuscripts remained unstudied for centuries because they were written in scripts and languages unfamiliar to European scholars who dominated the field of historical research. This situation suggests that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the manuscripts at Sankoré were less important to the history of scholarship than those held in European libraries. B) European scholars deliberately suppressed knowledge about the Sankoré library's holdings. C) gaps in scholarly attention can result from linguistic and cultural biases within the research community. D) the Sankoré Mosque library was primarily used for religious instruction rather than academic research.

MEDIUM (Q17-Q48)

Q17. [Medium]

Ecologist Renata Souza and her team studied how the removal of apex predators from a coastal ecosystem affected populations of mid-level predators and herbivores. After the local extinction of sea otters, populations of sea urchins—a prey species of otters—expanded dramatically and consumed vast stretches of kelp forest. The loss of kelp, in turn, deprived numerous fish and invertebrate species of shelter and food. Souza's findings illustrate a phenomenon ecologists call a trophic cascade, in which the removal of a single species triggers ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the immediate recovery of plant species that had been overgrazed. B) a chain of ecological disruptions that extend across multiple levels of the food web. C) a temporary period of increased biodiversity before the ecosystem stabilizes. D) the rapid replacement of the removed species by a functionally equivalent competitor.

Q18. [Medium]

Political scientist James Okoro analyzed voter turnout patterns in three democracies and found that countries with compulsory voting laws consistently reported turnout rates above 90 percent, while countries with voluntary voting averaged approximately 60 percent. Okoro cautioned, however, that high turnout in compulsory-voting countries does not necessarily indicate high civic engagement, since voters who are legally required to cast ballots may do so without researching candidates or issues.

What does the text most strongly imply about compulsory voting?

A) Compulsory voting guarantees that elected officials accurately represent the preferences of the entire population. B) Compulsory voting laws are primarily designed to benefit incumbent politicians by discouraging opposition voters. C) Countries with voluntary voting produce more informed electorates than countries with compulsory voting do. D) Although compulsory voting increases the number of ballots cast, it may not proportionally increase the quality of democratic participation.

Q19. [Medium]

Neuroscientist Ana Vega investigated whether bilingual individuals experience cognitive advantages when switching between tasks. She compared the performance of bilingual and monolingual adults on a task-switching exercise in which participants rapidly alternated between sorting shapes by color and sorting them by size. Bilingual participants completed the exercise with fewer errors but did not complete it faster. Vega proposed that bilingualism may enhance accuracy in task-switching by strengthening the brain's ability to suppress competing responses, even if it does not accelerate processing speed. This proposal suggests that the cognitive advantage of bilingualism in task-switching is best characterized as ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) an improvement in the precision of executive control rather than in the velocity of cognitive processing. B) a temporary benefit that diminishes as bilingual individuals age and their language skills decline. C) a general

enhancement of all cognitive abilities, including memory, attention, and processing speed. D) an artifact of bilingual participants' greater familiarity with standardized testing formats.

Q20. [Medium]

During the construction of the Hoover Dam in the 1930s, engineers faced the challenge of pouring an unprecedented volume of concrete—enough to build a two-lane highway from San Francisco to New York. If poured as a single mass, the concrete would have generated enough heat during curing to remain dangerously hot for over a century. To solve this problem, engineers divided the dam into individual columns and circulated ice-cold river water through embedded pipes to absorb the heat. The engineers' solution demonstrates that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) constructing the dam as a single mass would have been less expensive than dividing it into columns. B) the concrete used in the Hoover Dam was chemically different from concrete used in modern construction. C) large-scale engineering projects sometimes require novel techniques to manage physical processes that would be negligible at smaller scales. D) river water is generally more effective at absorbing heat than industrially produced coolants.

Q21. [Medium]

Linguist Fatima Khoury studied the phenomenon of code-switching—alternating between two languages within a single conversation—among trilingual speakers in Beirut. Khoury found that speakers did not switch languages randomly; instead, they tended to use Arabic for emotional expressions, French for formal or academic topics, and English for technology-related vocabulary. Khoury argued that code-switching in this community reflects not linguistic confusion but rather a sophisticated sensitivity to the social and contextual associations each language carries.

As presented in the text, Khoury would most likely agree with which statement about code-switching among the trilingual speakers she studied?

A) Code-switching occurs primarily because speakers lack sufficient vocabulary in any one of their three languages. B) The practice of code-switching is unique to trilingual communities in Beirut and has not been observed elsewhere. C) Code-switching is a transitional phase that diminishes as speakers become more proficient in their dominant language. D) Speakers' choices about which language to use in a given moment are deliberate and contextually motivated.

Q22. [Medium]

Paleontologist Victor Ramos examined fossilized dinosaur trackways—sequences of footprints preserved in ancient mud—in a region of Patagonia. He observed that trackways belonging to large sauropods consistently appeared alongside, and never overlapping with, trackways belonging to smaller theropods. This pattern, Ramos noted, was consistent across multiple sites spanning several million years. Ramos proposed that the two groups of dinosaurs may have used shared landscapes but at different times—possibly with sauropods moving through open floodplains during the wet season and theropods frequenting the same areas during drier periods. However, Ramos conceded that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the trackways could also be explained by the two groups deliberately avoiding each other to minimize predation risk, regardless of seasonal patterns. B) fossilized trackways are generally unreliable indicators of dinosaur behavior because erosion frequently distorts their original shapes. C) sauropods and theropods were incapable of coexisting in the same ecosystem due to competition for identical food sources. D) the presence of both sauropod and theropod trackways at the same sites proves that the two groups traveled together in mixed herds.

Q23. [Medium]

Anthropologist Nia Osei studied gift-giving practices in three West African communities and found that the value of gifts exchanged during weddings has increased substantially over the past two decades, even after adjusting for inflation. Osei observed that families often go into debt to meet rising expectations for wedding gifts. She also found that young couples who received more expensive wedding gifts were not measurably happier in their first five years of marriage than those who received more modest gifts. These findings together suggest that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) couples who receive expensive wedding gifts tend to divorce at higher rates than couples who receive modest gifts. B) the communities Osei studied place less importance on marriage as an institution than they did two decades ago. C) wedding gift inflation imposes financial costs on families without delivering a proportional benefit to the couples receiving the gifts. D) inflation-adjusted gift values have remained stable across all types of ceremonial occasions, not only weddings.

Q24. [Medium]

Physicist Hana Takahashi and her team developed a new method for producing thin films of gallium nitride, a semiconductor material used in LEDs and power electronics. Conventional methods require temperatures above 1,000 degrees Celsius and produce films with defect densities of approximately 10^8 per square centimeter. Takahashi's technique operates at only 600 degrees Celsius and yields films with defect densities below 10^6 per square centimeter. Despite these advantages, the process is significantly slower than conventional methods, producing films at roughly one-tenth the rate. For manufacturers considering adopting Takahashi's technique, the decision will likely hinge on _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) whether the improved film quality justifies the reduced production speed for their specific applications. B) whether gallium nitride can be replaced by a less expensive semiconductor material. C) how quickly other research teams can replicate Takahashi's results using conventional equipment. D) whether consumers are willing to pay higher prices for LEDs produced at lower temperatures.

Q25. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from a 1946 essay by literary critic Dayo Abiodun. Abiodun is discussing the novels of a fictional author, Constance Wyatt.

Wyatt's admirers praise her dialogue for its uncanny verisimilitude—characters speak, they say, exactly as people do. But this is only half true, and the less interesting half. Wyatt's characters speak as people would if they were suddenly, miraculously articulate about their own confusion. Her genius lies not in mimicry but in clarification: she gives her characters the words that real people feel but cannot find.

As presented in the text, Abiodun would most likely agree with which statement about Wyatt's writing?

A) Wyatt's dialogue is most effective when her characters express emotions that real people rarely experience. B) Wyatt's achievement is not the realistic reproduction of ordinary speech but the illumination of emotions that ordinary speech fails to express. C) Wyatt's admirers correctly identify verisimilitude as her greatest literary strength. D) Wyatt's characters are unrealistic because real people are never able to articulate their feelings clearly.

Q26. [Medium]

In a 2023 study, marine biologist Kofi Mensah compared the foraging behavior of two populations of bottlenose dolphins—one in a shallow bay and one in the open ocean. Bay dolphins used a technique called "mud ring feeding," in which a dolphin swims in tight circles to stir up sediment, trapping fish inside a ring of murky water. Ocean dolphins, by contrast, hunted cooperatively by herding fish into dense clusters near the surface. Mensah noted that juvenile dolphins in each population learned their respective technique by observing and imitating adults. The fact that the two populations use distinct foraging strategies acquired through social learning

suggests that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) bay dolphins are genetically predisposed to mud ring feeding, while ocean dolphins are genetically predisposed to cooperative herding. B) the foraging techniques used by both populations are less efficient than techniques used by solitary dolphin species. C) open-ocean dolphins would be unable to learn mud ring feeding even if they were relocated to a shallow bay. D) dolphin foraging behavior is influenced not only by innate ability but also by culturally transmitted knowledge specific to each population's environment.

Q27. [Medium]

Economist Selin Arslan analyzed housing prices in twelve mid-sized cities and found that proximity to newly constructed public transit stations was associated with increased property values within a one-mile radius. However, Arslan also found that the increase was unevenly distributed: properties within a quarter mile of stations experienced price increases of roughly 20 percent, while those between a half mile and one mile saw increases of only 3 percent. Additionally, rental prices in the quarter-mile radius rose by nearly 15 percent, leading some longtime tenants to relocate. Arslan's findings suggest that the benefits of transit investment ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) primarily benefit renters rather than homeowners because of improved access to transportation. B) are distributed equally among all residents living within one mile of new transit stations. C) are concentrated among property owners closest to stations and may come at the expense of affordability for nearby renters. D) diminish entirely beyond a quarter-mile radius of the transit station.

Q28. [Medium]

Text 1 Historian Laura Chen argues that the printing press, introduced in Europe by Johannes Gutenberg around 1440, was the primary catalyst for the Protestant Reformation. By making books affordable, the press allowed reformers like Martin Luther to distribute their critiques of Catholic Church practices to a wide audience, undermining the Church's control over religious interpretation.

Text 2 Historian Ravi Gupta contends that while the printing press accelerated the spread of reformist ideas, it was not a sufficient cause of the Reformation. Gupta points out that printing technology had existed in East Asia for centuries without producing a comparable religious upheaval, suggesting that the specific social, political, and economic conditions of sixteenth-century Europe were at least as important as the technology itself.

Based on the texts, how would Gupta most likely respond to Chen's argument?

A) By arguing that the printing press had no meaningful impact on the spread of Reformation ideas in Europe. B) By suggesting that Chen's argument overemphasizes the role of technology and underestimates the importance of the broader historical context that made the Reformation possible. C) By claiming that the printing press was used more effectively in East Asia than in Europe during the sixteenth century. D) By asserting that Martin Luther would have achieved the same influence even without access to printed materials.

Q29. [Medium]

Mycologist Ingrid Holm discovered that a species of fungus growing on the roots of birch trees in Scandinavian forests produces a compound that inhibits the growth of a common bacterial pathogen. In laboratory experiments, extracts of the fungus reduced bacterial colony formation by 87 percent. However, when Holm tested the compound on infected plant tissue, the reduction was only 34 percent. Holm hypothesized that other microorganisms present on the plant tissue may interact with the compound in ways that diminish its antibacterial effectiveness. This hypothesis suggests that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the compound is unlikely to have any practical applications in agriculture or medicine. B) the fungus produces the antibacterial compound only when it is growing in association with birch tree roots. C) laboratory

experiments consistently overestimate the effectiveness of all naturally derived antibacterial compounds. D) the antibacterial properties of the compound may be modulated by the complex microbial communities found in natural environments.

Q30. [Medium]

In a study of workplace productivity, organizational psychologist Miguel Torres asked employees at a technology firm to log the number of times they were interrupted by colleagues during focused work sessions. Torres found that employees who were interrupted more than five times per hour reported significantly lower task completion rates and higher levels of frustration. Interestingly, however, employees who were interrupted two to four times per hour reported higher satisfaction than employees who were never interrupted, even though their task completion rates were also lower than those of the uninterrupted group. Torres suggested that moderate levels of interruption may fulfill a social need that outweighs the productivity cost for some workers.

What does the text most strongly imply about the relationship between interruptions and employee satisfaction?

A) The relationship is straightforward: fewer interruptions always lead to greater satisfaction. B) Satisfaction depends solely on whether interruptions come from peers or supervisors. C) The relationship is nonlinear, with moderate interruptions associated with higher satisfaction than either very frequent or zero interruptions. D) Employees who are never interrupted are the least productive workers in the firm.

Q31. [Medium]

Botanist Clara Engström investigated why a species of alpine wildflower produces seeds with an unusually thick outer coating. She hypothesized that the coating protects seeds during extended periods of dormancy in frozen soil. To test this, Engström compared germination rates of seeds stored at -20°C for one, three, and five years. After one year, thick-coated and thin-coated seeds germinated at similar rates. After five years, however, thick-coated seeds germinated at a rate of 72 percent, while thin-coated seeds germinated at only 19 percent. Engström's results support the hypothesis because they demonstrate that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) thick seed coatings provide a significant advantage specifically under conditions of prolonged cold exposure. B) thin-coated seeds are incapable of surviving even brief periods of freezing temperatures. C) seed coat thickness has no measurable effect on germination when seeds are stored at temperatures above freezing. D) all alpine wildflower species produce seeds with thick outer coatings.

Q32. [Medium]

Author Simone Lavalley's novels are often praised for their intricate plots, but Lavalley herself has said in interviews that she considers plot secondary to what she calls "emotional architecture"—the way a novel arranges and sequences its emotional experiences to create a cumulative psychological effect on the reader. She has cited as an example her decision, in one novel, to place a joyful reunion scene immediately after a devastating loss, not because the plot demanded that sequence but because the juxtaposition intensified the reader's experience of both emotions.

As presented in the text, Lavalley would most likely agree with which statement?

A) The emotional structure of a novel can be as deliberately crafted as its narrative events and may even take priority over plot logic. B) A novel's plot should always be subordinated to its thematic concerns. C) Readers generally prefer novels with intricate plots over novels that emphasize emotional experiences. D) Joy and grief are the only emotions that benefit from deliberate juxtaposition in fiction.

Q33. [Medium]

Geographers studying desertification in the Sahel region of Africa have documented a pattern in which the removal of deep-rooted trees for agricultural use leads to a decline in groundwater levels. Deep-rooted trees draw water from underground aquifers and release it into the topsoil through a process called hydraulic

redistribution. When these trees are cleared, the topsoil dries out, making it increasingly difficult for crops and remaining vegetation to survive. Ironically, the agricultural expansion that drives tree removal may therefore

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) have no measurable effect on the region's long-term water supply. B) lead to the discovery of previously unknown underground water sources. C) encourage the development of crop varieties that do not require access to groundwater. D) ultimately undermine the very agricultural productivity it was intended to enhance.

Q34. [Medium]

Text 1 Art conservator Diana Morales advocates for "minimal intervention" in the restoration of damaged paintings, arguing that restorers should stabilize deteriorating materials but avoid reconstructing missing elements. Morales contends that speculative reconstruction—filling in lost areas based on what the restorer believes the artist intended—inevitably introduces the restorer's own aesthetic judgments and can distort the original work.

Text 2 Art conservator Henrik Bjornsson argues that leaving visible gaps in a damaged painting can be just as distorting as speculative reconstruction. Bjornsson points out that a prominent area of damage draws the viewer's attention away from the composition as the artist designed it, and that a carefully executed reconstruction based on thorough research can actually bring the viewer closer to the artist's original vision.

Based on the texts, how would Bjornsson most likely respond to Morales's position?

A) By arguing that all forms of restoration inevitably alter the original work and should therefore be avoided entirely. B) By conceding that speculative reconstruction is unreliable but proposing that digital imaging can replace physical restoration. C) By suggesting that leaving damage visible introduces its own form of distortion by disrupting the viewer's experience of the composition. D) By claiming that Morales's approach is appropriate for minor damage but not for paintings with significant missing elements.

Q35. [Medium]

Astronomer Kenji Fujimoto studied a class of stars known as red giants that exhibit unexpected fluctuations in brightness. Conventional models predict that red giants should dim and brighten in regular, predictable cycles as their outer layers expand and contract. Fujimoto, however, documented several red giants whose brightness patterns were erratic, with sudden flares followed by prolonged dimming. He proposed that these anomalies could be caused by large convective cells—massive upwellings of hot gas from the star's interior—that temporarily disrupt the regular pulsation cycle.

Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Fujimoto's proposal?

A) Red giants with erratic brightness patterns are found exclusively in binary star systems. B) Computer simulations of convective cells in stellar interiors produce brightness fluctuations that closely match the patterns Fujimoto observed. C) Most red giants observed by other astronomers display the regular pulsation cycles predicted by conventional models. D) The chemical composition of red giants with erratic brightness differs significantly from that of red giants with regular cycles.

Q36. [Medium]

Nutritional scientist Amara Obi examined the effects of soil mineral content on the nutritional profiles of leafy green vegetables. She grew identical cultivars of spinach in soils with varying concentrations of iron and zinc. Plants grown in iron-rich soil contained 40 percent more iron per gram of leaf tissue than those grown in standard soil, but showed no increase in zinc content—even when zinc was also present in elevated amounts. Obi proposed that spinach plants possess selective uptake mechanisms that respond differently to each mineral. Obi's proposal implies that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) increasing the mineral content of soil will reliably increase the nutritional value of all crops grown in that soil. B) iron and zinc compete for the same absorption pathways in spinach root systems. C) spinach is the only vegetable species with selective mineral uptake mechanisms. D) enriching soil with a particular mineral will not necessarily increase the plant's absorption of that mineral.

Q37. [Medium]

Historian Tomoko Nishida argues that the popular narrative of Japan's rapid industrialization during the Meiji era (1868–1912) often overlooks the contributions of rural textile workers, most of whom were women. While accounts of the period typically emphasize the construction of railroads, steel mills, and shipyards, Nishida points out that silk and cotton exports—produced largely by female labor in rural workshops—generated much of the foreign currency that financed those industrial projects. Nishida therefore contends that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) Japan's industrialization would have proceeded at the same pace without the revenue from textile exports. B) the standard narrative of Meiji industrialization should be expanded to acknowledge the foundational role of rural women's labor. C) rural textile production was technologically more sophisticated than railroad construction during the Meiji era. D) historians have deliberately minimized the role of women in Japan's industrialization to promote a male-centered narrative.

Q38. [Medium]

Behavioral ecologist Yusuf Haddad observed that a species of tropical bird called the velvet weaver constructs two types of nests: an elaborate, brightly decorated nest used during courtship displays and a simpler, camouflaged nest where eggs are actually incubated. Haddad noted that males who built more visually striking display nests attracted more mates but experienced higher rates of nest predation on their display nests. Incubation nests, regardless of the builder's display-nest quality, suffered similar predation rates across all males. This pattern suggests that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) males who build less elaborate display nests are more successful at raising offspring to adulthood. B) predators are unable to distinguish between display nests and incubation nests. C) the elaborate display nests attract predators, but this cost does not extend to the incubation nests because they are separately located and concealed. D) the predation rates on display nests have no effect on the reproductive success of velvet weavers.

Q39. [Medium]

Philosopher Amira Kassem has argued that the concept of "authenticity" in food culture is inherently paradoxical. She notes that dishes widely considered authentic—Neapolitan pizza, for instance—are themselves the products of centuries of cross-cultural borrowing and adaptation. Tomatoes, a defining ingredient of Neapolitan pizza, were introduced to Italy from the Americas only in the sixteenth century. Kassem concludes that labeling any cuisine as "authentic" requires arbitrarily selecting a point in history and treating the dish's form at that moment as fixed, even though ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) most consumers prefer traditional recipes to modern adaptations. B) Neapolitan pizza has remained unchanged since the sixteenth century. C) the dish was itself the result of ongoing change and exchange before and after that point. D) food historians rarely study the origins of individual ingredients.

Q40. [Medium]

In a randomized experiment, psychologist Wei Chen assigned 200 participants to one of two conditions. In the first condition, participants wrote about a personal failure and then read a brief essay arguing that failure is a normal and necessary part of growth. In the second condition, participants wrote about a personal failure but received no follow-up essay. When asked to attempt a challenging puzzle one week later, participants in the first

condition persisted for an average of 14 minutes, compared to 9 minutes for participants in the second condition. Chen concluded that reframing failure as constructive can increase subsequent persistence.

Which statement, if true, would most directly weaken Chen's conclusion?

A) The participants in the first condition happened, by random chance, to score significantly higher on a pre-study measure of dispositional persistence than participants in the second condition. B) Participants in both conditions reported similar levels of discomfort when writing about personal failures. C) Participants in the first condition reported finding the puzzle more enjoyable than participants in the second condition did. D) Some participants in the first condition reported that they did not read the follow-up essay carefully.

Q41. [Medium]

Urban planner Sofia Delgado studied three cities that had converted former industrial waterfronts into public parks. In each city, residential property values within a half mile of the new park increased by an average of 12 percent within five years. Delgado noted, however, that the increase was accompanied by a 30 percent rise in rental prices in the same areas, leading to significant displacement of low-income residents. She argued that cities planning similar projects should pair waterfront redevelopment with affordable housing protections. Delgado's argument most directly implies that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) waterfront parks are less beneficial to cities than parks located in non-waterfront areas. B) the economic benefits of urban park development can produce inequitable outcomes if not accompanied by policy safeguards. C) low-income residents do not benefit from increased property values in their neighborhoods. D) cities should avoid converting industrial waterfronts into public parks under any circumstances.

Q42. [Medium]

Entomologist Rosa Martínez discovered that a species of beetle native to cloud forests in Costa Rica uses a combination of chemical and acoustic signals to attract mates. Males produce a pheromone that draws females to a general area, then generate a species-specific clicking sound by rubbing their wing covers together. Martínez found that females consistently chose males whose clicks were louder and more rhythmically regular, even when the pheromone signals of competing males were equally strong. This finding implies that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) pheromone signals are irrelevant to mate selection in this beetle species. B) female beetles of this species are unable to detect pheromone signals at distances greater than one meter. C) males with louder clicks produce pheromones that are chemically distinct from those of quieter males. D) acoustic signals serve as a secondary selection criterion that allows females to discriminate among males once pheromones have attracted them to the same area.

Q43. [Medium]

Archaeologist Samuel Okafor excavated a site in the Niger River valley and uncovered iron smelting furnaces dating to approximately 800 BCE—several centuries earlier than the oldest known iron-working sites in the broader West African region. Some scholars had previously theorized that ironworking technology in West Africa diffused from a single point of origin in the Great Lakes region of East Africa. Okafor's discovery complicates this theory because it ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) proves that ironworking was invented simultaneously in multiple locations around the world. B) suggests that West African ironworking may have developed independently, rather than originating from a single East African source. C) demonstrates that the Niger River valley had extensive trade connections with East Africa as early as 800 BCE. D) indicates that iron smelting in East Africa began later than 800 BCE.

Q44. [Medium]

Climate scientist Elif Aydın modeled the effects of planting reflective crops—varieties with lighter-colored leaves that bounce more sunlight back into space—on regional temperatures. Her models predicted that replacing standard wheat varieties with reflective cultivars across southern Europe could reduce peak summer temperatures by approximately 1°C in agricultural zones. However, Aydın acknowledged that the reflective cultivars currently available produce 8 to 12 percent lower grain yields than standard varieties. For farmers considering a switch, _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) the decision will depend on whether the cooling benefits are perceived as sufficient to offset the reduction in crop output. B) the reflective cultivars will inevitably prove more profitable because of reduced irrigation costs. C) the temperature reduction would eliminate the need for any other climate adaptation strategies in southern Europe. D) the yield difference between reflective and standard varieties is too small to affect farm income.
-

Q45. [Medium]

Text 1 Musicologist Priya Banerjee argues that the Western classical music canon—the set of works regularly performed by orchestras—has remained largely static for decades, with concerts dominated by the same compositions of Mozart, Beethoven, and Brahms. Banerjee contends that this conservatism reflects institutional inertia and audience expectations rather than any genuine artistic judgment that canonical works are superior to all alternatives.

Text 2 Conductor Esteban Ríos acknowledges that orchestral programming is repetitive but attributes this to practical constraints rather than inertia. Rehearsal time is limited and expensive, Ríos explains, so orchestras tend to program familiar works that musicians can prepare quickly. Introducing unfamiliar pieces requires significantly more rehearsal, which increases costs without guaranteeing comparable ticket revenue.

Based on the texts, how would Ríos most likely respond to Banerjee's characterization of the orchestral canon's stability?

- A) By agreeing that institutional inertia is the primary cause but adding that audience expectations play no role. B) By suggesting that audiences genuinely prefer canonical works because of their superior artistic quality. C) By arguing that the orchestral canon has actually changed significantly in recent decades. D) By offering an alternative explanation that emphasizes economic and logistical factors rather than institutional complacency.
-

Q46. [Medium]

Geneticist Leila Marzouki studied a population of Arctic foxes on an isolated island and found that, despite numbering fewer than 300 individuals, the population maintained higher genetic diversity than expected. Marzouki discovered that females in the population consistently chose mates whose genetic profiles were most dissimilar from their own—a strategy known as disassortative mating. She proposed that this behavioral mechanism acts as a buffer against the loss of genetic diversity that small, isolated populations typically experience.

Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Marzouki's proposal?

- A) Arctic fox populations on the mainland, which number in the thousands, also exhibit disassortative mating. B) The island population of Arctic foxes has experienced several severe weather events that temporarily reduced its numbers. C) Computer simulations show that small populations practicing disassortative mating retain significantly more genetic diversity over time than equivalently sized populations mating at random. D) Female Arctic foxes in the island population choose mates based on territory size rather than genetic compatibility.
-

Q47. [Medium]

The following text is adapted from a 1934 novel by Claudette Moreau. The narrator, Lucien, is a schoolteacher reflecting on a former student.

I had always assumed that Bernard's silence in class was the silence of incomprehension—the blank stillness of a mind that had simply stopped reaching for the answer. Years later, reading his extraordinary first novel, I understood my error. His silence had been the silence of a mind so crowded with ideas that speech seemed a grotesque reduction. He had not failed to think; he had failed only to find any thought small enough to fit inside a sentence spoken aloud in a schoolroom.

What does the text most strongly imply about Lucien's earlier assessment of Bernard?

A) Lucien correctly identified Bernard as an exceptionally gifted student but chose not to intervene. B) Lucien mistook Bernard's intellectual richness for intellectual deficiency. C) Lucien deliberately discouraged Bernard from speaking in class to avoid disrupting other students. D) Lucien recognized Bernard's potential but lacked the resources to support his development.

Q48. [Medium]

Public health researcher Dara Kimani studied the effectiveness of a text-message reminder system designed to improve medication adherence among patients with chronic conditions. Patients who received daily text reminders took their medications on schedule 78 percent of the time, compared to 61 percent for patients who received no reminders. However, when Kimani followed up six months after the reminder system was discontinued, adherence rates in the reminder group had declined to 63 percent—nearly identical to the control group's rate. These findings suggest that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) text-message reminders can improve medication adherence while active but may not produce lasting behavioral changes once removed. B) patients who received text reminders developed worse medication habits than patients who never received reminders. C) the text-message reminder system was too expensive to be practical for long-term use. D) medication adherence is primarily determined by factors unrelated to patient behavior, such as drug availability.

HARD (Q49–Q80)

Q49. [Hard]

Astrophysicist Mei-Ling Zhou and her team analyzed the orbital mechanics of a binary star system in which a smaller, dimmer companion star orbits a larger primary at an unexpectedly close distance. Conventional models predict that at such proximity, tidal forces from the primary should gradually strip material from the companion's outer layers, causing the companion to lose mass over time. However, Zhou's spectroscopic measurements showed that the companion's mass has remained stable for at least the past three million years. She proposed that a strong magnetic field generated by the companion deflects the tidal forces sufficiently to prevent mass transfer. This proposal would be most weakened if it were demonstrated that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the companion star's magnetic field strength is comparable to that of stars in similar binary systems that do experience mass transfer. B) the primary star in the system generates a weaker magnetic field than most stars of its size. C) tidal forces in binary systems are influenced by the orbital eccentricity of the smaller star. D) the companion star is younger than three million years old.

Q50. [Hard]

Cognitive psychologist Rajan Mehta investigated the "illusion of explanatory depth"—the tendency for people to believe they understand complex systems more thoroughly than they actually do. Mehta asked participants to rate their understanding of everyday devices such as zippers and flush toilets on a scale from 1 to 7. Then he asked them to write detailed, step-by-step explanations of how each device works. After writing their explanations, participants re-rated their understanding, and their scores dropped by an average of 2.3 points.

Mehta noted, however, that the drop was significantly smaller for participants who had professional experience with mechanical devices, even when those participants' initial ratings were equally high. This finding suggests that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the illusion of explanatory depth is primarily a function of overconfidence rather than lack of knowledge. B) participants with professional experience were less willing to lower their self-ratings because of professional pride. C) professional experience provides genuine understanding that partially withstands the challenge of articulating a detailed explanation, while non-experts' confidence is more superficial. D) detailed step-by-step explanations are not a valid method for measuring actual understanding of mechanical devices.

Q51. [Hard]

Text 1 Sociologist Amara Diallo argues that the decline of local newspapers in the United States has weakened democratic accountability. She points to research showing that municipalities that have lost their local newspaper experienced increases in government spending, bond issuance costs, and instances of public corruption. Diallo contends that local journalists serve as watchdogs whose presence alone deters governmental misconduct.

Text 2 Media scholar Jonas Eriksson cautions against overstating the watchdog effect of local newspapers. Eriksson notes that many of the municipalities studied in the research Diallo cites were experiencing economic decline before their newspapers closed—conditions that independently increase government spending and corruption. The loss of the newspaper, Eriksson argues, may be a symptom of the same economic deterioration rather than a cause of democratic dysfunction.

Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 would most likely respond to the argument in Text 2 by making which of the following claims?

A) Economic decline in municipalities has no relationship to changes in government spending or corruption. B) The closure of local newspapers is never caused by economic decline but rather by changes in reader preferences. C) Local newspapers rarely report on government misconduct and therefore cannot function as deterrents. D) Even if economic conditions contribute to the observed outcomes, the independent deterrent effect of local journalism should not be discounted, as municipalities with surviving newspapers in similar economic conditions show better governance metrics.

Q52. [Hard]

Neuroscientist Lena Hoffmann examined how the brain processes ambiguous visual stimuli. She presented participants with images that could be interpreted as either a duck or a rabbit, depending on the viewer's perspective. Using functional MRI, Hoffmann observed that participants who perceived the image as a duck showed heightened activity in brain regions associated with processing round shapes, while those who perceived a rabbit showed activation in regions associated with processing elongated forms. Crucially, when participants were informed that both interpretations were possible and asked to switch their perception, the pattern of brain activity shifted to match the new interpretation. Hoffmann's findings imply that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the brain's interpretation of ambiguous images is fixed at the moment of initial perception and cannot be altered by conscious effort. B) ambiguous visual stimuli activate entirely different neural pathways depending on the viewer's prior familiarity with the objects depicted. C) conscious awareness can redirect the brain's perceptual processing, causing the same stimulus to activate different neural regions depending on the intended interpretation. D) the duck-rabbit illusion is perceived identically by all viewers, regardless of cultural background or visual experience.

Q53. [Hard]

Economist Nadia Petrova studied the labor market effects of automating routine tasks in a large financial

services firm. Over a three-year period following the introduction of automated document-processing software, the firm eliminated 40 percent of its clerical positions. However, the number of employees in analytical and client-facing roles increased by 25 percent during the same period, and the firm's total employment declined by only 12 percent. Petrova observed that many displaced clerical workers were retrained for the new analytical positions, but those who lacked college degrees were significantly less likely to be selected for retraining. Petrova's observation suggests that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) automation uniformly benefits all workers by creating more intellectually stimulating positions. B) the financial services firm should have automated its analytical functions rather than its clerical functions. C) workers without college degrees are inherently less capable of performing analytical tasks. D) the net employment effects of automation may be moderate, but the distribution of those effects is uneven, with less-educated workers bearing a disproportionate share of the costs.

Q54. [Hard]

Paleoclimatologist Jin-Woo Park analyzed ice cores from Greenland to reconstruct atmospheric methane concentrations over the past 12,000 years. He found that methane levels remained relatively stable from 10,000 BCE to about 3,000 BCE, then began a gradual, sustained rise that continued until the industrial era. Park noted that this inflection point coincided approximately with the expansion of rice agriculture in East and Southeast Asia—a practice that involves flooding fields, creating anaerobic conditions ideal for methane-producing microorganisms. However, some critics argue that natural wetland expansion, driven by climatic changes during the same period, could account for the methane increase without invoking human activity. Park responded by pointing out that the climatic conditions associated with wetland expansion were present at similar levels during earlier periods of the Holocene when methane concentrations did not rise, suggesting that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) natural wetland expansion is the sole cause of the methane increase observed after 3,000 BCE. B) climatic conditions alone are insufficient to explain the post-3,000 BCE rise, which is more consistent with an anthropogenic source such as rice cultivation. C) methane-producing microorganisms were not present in natural wetlands before 3,000 BCE. D) ice core records from Greenland are unreliable indicators of global atmospheric methane concentrations.

Q55. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from a 1952 essay by philosopher Tadeo Villanueva.

We speak of "discovering" mathematical truths as though they existed before us, waiting in some timeless vault for the right mind to stumble upon them. But consider: no one says we "discover" a symphony or a legal code. These are made, not found, and mathematics may be no different. The integers, the theorems, the proofs—all may be human artifacts dressed in the costume of necessity, their apparent inevitability a trick of habit rather than evidence of a mind-independent reality.

As presented in the text, Villanueva would most likely agree with which statement?

A) Mathematical truths are objectively real and exist independently of human thought. B) Mathematics is less rigorous than other intellectual disciplines because it is a human invention. C) The belief that mathematics describes a pre-existing reality may be a cognitive illusion rather than a well-supported claim. D) Symphonies and legal codes are discovered in the same way that mathematical truths are.

Q56. [Hard]

Immunologist Felicia Nakamura studied the effectiveness of a new adjuvant—a substance added to vaccines to enhance the immune response—in elderly patients, who typically mount weaker responses to vaccination. In a clinical trial, elderly patients who received a flu vaccine with the new adjuvant produced antibody levels 60 percent higher than those who received the standard vaccine. However, Nakamura found that the enhanced

antibody production declined to levels comparable with the standard vaccine within eight months, while younger patients who received the adjuvant maintained elevated antibody levels for at least fourteen months. Nakamura hypothesized that age-related decline in immune cell function limits the duration of the adjuvant's effect. This hypothesis would be most strongly supported if _____

Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Nakamura's hypothesis?

A) Elderly patients who exercise regularly maintain elevated antibody levels for longer periods than sedentary elderly patients. B) Younger patients who received the standard vaccine without the adjuvant also maintained elevated antibody levels for fourteen months. C) The adjuvant has been shown to enhance antibody production against multiple types of pathogens, not just influenza. D) Elderly patients in the trial had significantly fewer of the immune cells responsible for sustaining long-term antibody production than younger patients.

Q57. [Hard]

Architectural historian Miriam Okonkwo has challenged the common characterization of Brutalist architecture as deliberately hostile to its users. Okonkwo acknowledges that Brutalist buildings—with their exposed concrete surfaces and monumental scale—are frequently criticized as cold and oppressive. However, she argues that many Brutalist architects, particularly those working in post-independence African nations during the 1960s and 1970s, conceived of their designs as expressions of democratic ambition: the massive public plazas and open corridors were intended to accommodate large gatherings and promote communal interaction. Okonkwo contends that the perception of hostility reflects a misreading that conflates the rawness of materials with a rawness of intent. Her argument implies that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) all Brutalist buildings were designed with the explicit goal of fostering democratic participation. B) the aesthetic qualities of a building's materials can lead observers to draw incorrect conclusions about the architect's purpose. C) Brutalist architecture is universally admired by the communities in which it is located. D) the architects of Brutalist buildings in post-independence African nations were unaware of how their designs would be perceived.

Q58. [Hard]

Biophysicist Arjun Desai developed a computational model to predict how proteins fold into their three-dimensional shapes. When tested against a database of 500 proteins with known structures, the model correctly predicted the folding pattern of 412 proteins. However, the 88 proteins for which the model's predictions were incorrect shared a common feature: they all contained unusually long regions of intrinsically disordered amino acids—sequences that do not fold into a fixed structure. Desai's model treats all amino acid sequences as converging toward a single lowest-energy configuration, which means it cannot account for regions that remain structurally variable. This limitation suggests that improving the model will require _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) removing intrinsically disordered proteins from the database against which the model is tested. B) increasing the number of proteins in the testing database to reduce the proportion of incorrect predictions. C) incorporating a framework that allows for multiple coexisting structural states within a single protein rather than assuming one fixed configuration. D) replacing the energy-based approach entirely with a model based on the evolutionary history of each protein.

Q59. [Hard]

Text 1 Literary critic Nkechi Azubuike argues that the unreliable narrator—a narrator whose account the reader has reason to distrust—is the defining innovation of modernist fiction. By embedding uncertainty within the act of storytelling itself, unreliable narration forces readers to become active interpreters rather than passive consumers of plot. Azubuike contends that this technique fundamentally altered the relationship between reader and text.

Text 2 Literary critic Oscar Lindqvist counters that unreliable narration predates modernism by centuries. He cites examples from medieval frame tales and eighteenth-century epistolary novels in which the narrator's credibility is explicitly questioned within the text. Lindqvist argues that what distinguishes modernist unreliable narration is not its existence but its subtlety: modernist writers obscure the narrator's unreliability rather than foregrounding it, making the reader's interpretive work more demanding but not categorically different.

Based on the texts, Lindqvist would most likely agree with which statement about Azubuike's argument?

A) Azubuike accurately identifies the interpretive demands of unreliable narration but incorrectly treats a refinement of an existing technique as an entirely new innovation. B) Azubuike is correct that unreliable narration originated in modernist fiction, but incorrect about its literary significance. C) Azubuike overlooks the fact that modernist fiction abandoned unreliable narration in favor of other experimental techniques. D) Azubuike's argument is undermined by the fact that readers of modernist fiction do not actively interpret texts.

Q60. [Hard]

Environmental engineer Thandiwe Moyo investigated the effectiveness of constructed wetlands—artificial marshes designed to filter pollutants from wastewater—in removing pharmaceutical residues. In laboratory-scale wetlands, removal rates for common pharmaceuticals exceeded 90 percent. In full-scale constructed wetlands serving actual communities, however, removal rates averaged only 55 percent. Moyo identified two factors contributing to the discrepancy: full-scale systems process much larger and more variable volumes of water, and they are exposed to seasonal temperature fluctuations that affect the microbial communities responsible for breaking down pharmaceutical compounds. Moyo's findings imply that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) constructed wetlands should be abandoned in favor of purely chemical water treatment methods. B) microbial communities in constructed wetlands are unaffected by temperature changes. C) pharmaceutical residues in wastewater pose no meaningful risk to public health. D) the performance gap between laboratory and full-scale systems reflects challenges of scale and environmental variability that laboratory conditions do not replicate.

Q61. [Hard]

Historian Claudia Ferrante documented a little-studied episode in which sixteenth-century Venetian glassmakers on the island of Murano were prohibited by law from leaving the republic. The Venetian Senate imposed these restrictions because the glassmakers possessed trade secrets—particularly the formula for *cristallo*, an exceptionally clear glass—that were commercially invaluable. Ferrante argues that the restrictions were not purely protective; they also reflected an emerging concept of intellectual property in which technical knowledge was treated as a state asset. However, she notes that several glassmakers did flee to other European cities, suggesting that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the Venetian Senate's restrictions successfully prevented the spread of *cristallo* production techniques to other European cities. B) glassmakers in other European cities had independently developed techniques for producing *cristallo* before the Venetian restrictions were enacted. C) the commercial value of the glassmakers' knowledge created incentives powerful enough to motivate individuals to defy legal prohibitions and accept personal risk. D) the Venetian Senate's concept of intellectual property was identical in its legal structure to modern patent law.

Q62. [Hard]

Developmental psychologist Yuki Tanaka studied how children between the ages of four and six understand the concept of fairness. She presented children with a scenario in which two puppets had performed unequal amounts of work and then gave the children a set of stickers to distribute between the puppets. Four-year-olds overwhelmingly divided the stickers equally regardless of work performed. Six-year-olds, however, tended to give more stickers to the puppet that had worked harder—but only when the scenario was described as

involving "earned rewards." When the stickers were described simply as "gifts," six-year-olds also divided them equally. Tanaka's findings suggest that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) children younger than four have no concept of fairness whatsoever. B) the concept of fairness is culturally determined and varies significantly across societies. C) six-year-olds are incapable of dividing resources equally under any circumstances. D) the development of merit-based fairness reasoning in children is not merely age-dependent but is also activated by contextual framing that signals an earned-reward scenario.
-

Q63. [Hard]

Text 1 Epidemiologist Grace Liang published a study concluding that outdoor air pollution is a more significant risk factor for childhood asthma than indoor air quality. Liang's study tracked 3,000 children in ten cities over five years and found that children living in areas with higher concentrations of nitrogen dioxide, an outdoor pollutant primarily from vehicle emissions, were 2.4 times more likely to develop asthma than children in low-pollution areas, even after controlling for household factors such as smoking, pet ownership, and housing age.

Text 2 Pediatric researcher Carlos Medina argues that Liang's study, while rigorous, may underestimate the role of indoor air quality. Medina notes that the study controlled for known indoor pollutant sources but did not measure actual indoor air pollutant concentrations. He points out that volatile organic compounds (VOCs) from building materials, cleaning products, and cooking can accumulate to high concentrations indoors—often exceeding outdoor levels—and that some of these compounds are known respiratory irritants. Without direct measurement of indoor VOC levels, Medina argues, the study cannot conclusively attribute the elevated asthma risk solely to outdoor pollution.

Based on the texts, how would Medina most likely characterize Liang's study?

- A) The study is fundamentally flawed because it relies on self-reported data about childhood asthma diagnoses. B) The study's controls for indoor air quality, while reasonable, may not fully capture indoor pollutant exposure, potentially inflating the apparent contribution of outdoor pollution. C) The study's conclusion is correct, but its sample size is too small to be statistically meaningful. D) The study should have focused exclusively on indoor air quality rather than attempting to compare indoor and outdoor factors.
-

Q64. [Hard]

Evolutionary biologist Keiko Matsuda investigated why certain deep-sea fish species possess functional eyes despite living in perpetual darkness at depths below 1,000 meters, where sunlight never penetrates. She discovered that these fish produce bioluminescent signals—species-specific patterns of light emitted from photophores on their bodies—that serve as a means of identifying potential mates. Matsuda found that the spectral sensitivity of each species' eyes is precisely tuned to the wavelength of its own bioluminescent emissions, allowing individuals to detect conspecifics while remaining largely invisible to predators whose eyes are tuned to different wavelengths. This finding suggests that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) the presence of functional eyes in these deep-sea species was maintained by natural selection because the eyes serve an essential role in species-specific communication. B) deep-sea fish developed bioluminescence before they developed functional eyes. C) all deep-sea organisms rely on bioluminescence for communication. D) the eyes of deep-sea fish are structurally identical to those of fish living in sunlit surface waters.
-

Q65. [Hard]

Political theorist Aisha Kamara has argued that democratic deliberation—the process by which citizens discuss and debate policy issues—can paradoxically increase political polarization rather than reduce it. Kamara cites studies showing that when groups of like-minded individuals deliberate together, the group's collective position tends to shift toward a more extreme version of the position most members already held, a phenomenon known as group polarization. She contends that many institutional efforts to promote deliberation inadvertently create

ideologically homogeneous groups, thus exacerbating the very divisions they seek to resolve. Kamara's argument most directly implies that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) democratic deliberation is inherently harmful to democratic governance and should be abandoned. B) citizens who participate in deliberation become permanently more extreme in their political views. C) the composition of deliberative groups is a critical design variable: deliberation's effects depend on whether participants hold diverse or homogeneous views. D) group polarization occurs only in democratic societies and is absent in authoritarian systems.

Q66. [Hard]

Geochemist Olga Petrova analyzed the isotopic signatures of sulfur trapped in 2.5-billion-year-old rock formations. She found a pattern of mass-independent fractionation—a specific distribution of sulfur isotopes that occurs only when sulfur-containing gases in the atmosphere are exposed to ultraviolet radiation without being shielded by an ozone layer. Since an ozone layer requires free oxygen to form, the presence of mass-independent sulfur fractionation in these ancient rocks is consistent with the prevailing view that Earth's atmosphere contained negligible oxygen before the Great Oxidation Event approximately 2.4 billion years ago. However, Petrova discovered that rocks dating to just 50 million years before the Great Oxidation Event show a subtle but measurable weakening of the mass-independent fractionation signal. This weakening suggests that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the Great Oxidation Event occurred suddenly and without any preceding changes in atmospheric composition. B) ultraviolet radiation levels were higher 2.5 billion years ago than they are today. C) the sulfur isotope method is unreliable for dating rocks older than 2 billion years. D) small but increasing amounts of oxygen may have been accumulating in the atmosphere in the millions of years immediately preceding the Great Oxidation Event.

Q67. [Hard]

Psycholinguist Marco Bellini studied how bilingual speakers resolve lexical ambiguity—situations in which a word has different meanings in two languages. He presented Italian-English bilinguals with the English word "camera" (a photographic device) and measured how quickly they could identify its meaning. He found that participants took significantly longer to process "camera" than unambiguous English words, because "camera" also means "room" in Italian. Crucially, the processing delay persisted even when participants were tested in an exclusively English-language context with no Italian cues present. Bellini's results imply that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) bilingual speakers activate both languages simultaneously during word processing, even when the context strongly favors only one language. B) bilingual speakers process words more slowly than monolingual speakers in all situations, regardless of lexical ambiguity. C) the meaning of a word in one language has no influence on how that word is processed in another language. D) Italian-English bilinguals rely primarily on context clues to determine word meaning.

Q68. [Hard]

Text 1 Ecologist Fatou Diop argues that rewilding—the reintroduction of species to ecosystems from which they have been eliminated—is the most effective strategy for restoring degraded landscapes. Diop points to the successful reintroduction of wolves to Yellowstone National Park, which led to a cascade of ecological benefits, including the recovery of streamside vegetation, reduced soil erosion, and increased biodiversity.

Text 2 Conservation biologist Henrik Larsson expresses skepticism about generalizing from the Yellowstone example. Larsson notes that Yellowstone is an unusually large, well-protected reserve with minimal human settlement, conditions rarely replicated elsewhere. In landscapes dominated by agriculture and human

habitation, Larsson argues, reintroduced predators frequently come into conflict with livestock and human communities, generating opposition that can undermine the entire conservation effort. He suggests that in such landscapes, habitat restoration without predator reintroduction may achieve more durable ecological gains.

Based on the texts, Larsson would most likely agree with which statement about Diop's argument?

A) Diop's argument ignores the ecological benefits that resulted from the Yellowstone wolf reintroduction. B) Diop's argument is correct in principle but insufficiently attentive to the practical constraints that make rewilding difficult or counterproductive in landscapes significantly altered by human use. C) Rewilding has never produced measurable ecological benefits in any location. D) Habitat restoration is always more effective than rewilding, regardless of the landscape's characteristics.

Q69. [Hard]

Materials scientist Yara Osman developed a new composite material that combines ceramic fibers with a polymer matrix to create panels that are simultaneously lightweight and impact-resistant. In laboratory drop tests, the panels absorbed 35 percent more impact energy per unit weight than conventional aluminum panels while weighing 40 percent less. However, when Osman subjected the panels to repeated impacts simulating long-term use, she found that the polymer matrix gradually developed microfractures that reduced impact resistance by 50 percent after 200 cycles, whereas aluminum panels showed only a 10 percent decline after the same number of cycles. For applications requiring long-term durability, _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) repeated impact testing is irrelevant to real-world applications of the composite material. B) aluminum panels are universally superior to composite materials in every respect. C) the composite material's microfractures would heal spontaneously over time. D) the composite material's superior initial performance may be offset by its faster rate of degradation under repeated stress.

Q70. [Hard]

Anthropologist Sven Holmgren studied naming practices in a community of indigenous reindeer herders in northern Scandinavia. He found that herders assign individual names to each reindeer in their herd—sometimes numbering several hundred animals—and that these names often encode detailed information about the animal's physical characteristics, lineage, and behavioral tendencies. Holmgren documented that experienced herders could recall over 300 names and the associated information for each, a feat that impressed researchers specializing in expert memory. However, Holmgren cautioned against interpreting this ability as extraordinary in any general cognitive sense, noting that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the herders had received formal education in memory techniques at local schools. B) the naming system itself functions as a mnemonic framework that organizes information in contextually meaningful ways, making the recall less a feat of raw memory than a product of deep domain expertise. C) herders in other regions of Scandinavia do not name their reindeer and rely instead on ear tags. D) the ability to recall 300 names is within the normal range of human memory and does not require any specialized knowledge.

Q71. [Hard]

Biochemist Sandra Okello investigated the mechanism by which a soil bacterium, *Streptomyces viridochromogenes*, produces the herbicide bialaphos. She identified a gene cluster encoding the enzymes responsible for assembling the compound through a series of sequential chemical reactions. When Okello inactivated one of the genes in the middle of the cluster, the bacterium accumulated an intermediate compound that is not normally detectable. Unexpectedly, this intermediate compound exhibited potent antifungal properties—a biological activity entirely absent from the final herbicidal product. Okello's discovery implies that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the biosynthetic pathways of microorganisms can generate intermediate compounds with biological activities distinct from those of the pathway's end product, suggesting untapped pharmaceutical potential. B) the herbicidal properties of bialaphos are entirely attributable to the intermediate compound rather than to the final product. C) all soil bacteria produce intermediate compounds with antifungal properties. D) gene inactivation always results in the accumulation of biologically active intermediate compounds.

Q72. [Hard]

Text 1 Philosopher of science Rebecca Engel argues that scientific models should be evaluated primarily by their predictive accuracy. A model that reliably predicts experimental outcomes, Engel contends, is scientifically valuable even if its underlying assumptions are known to be false. She cites the continued use of Newtonian mechanics in engineering as an example: although superseded by general relativity, Newtonian mechanics remains indispensable because its predictions are sufficiently accurate for most practical purposes.

Text 2 Philosopher of science Dmitri Volkov maintains that predictive accuracy, while important, is insufficient as the sole criterion for evaluating scientific models. Volkov argues that models also serve explanatory purposes—they help scientists understand why phenomena occur, not merely predict that they will. A model with high predictive accuracy but false assumptions may generate correct outputs without illuminating the mechanisms responsible for those outputs, leaving scientists unable to anticipate when and how the model will fail.

Based on the texts, how would Volkov most likely respond to Engel's example of Newtonian mechanics?

A) By pointing out that Newtonian mechanics is no longer used in any branch of science or engineering. B) By claiming that Newtonian mechanics and general relativity are equally accurate in all contexts. C) By arguing that the example actually supports his position because Newtonian mechanics' false assumptions about gravity prevent it from predicting phenomena like gravitational lensing, illustrating the limitations of prioritizing prediction over explanatory accuracy. D) By suggesting that Engel should have used quantum mechanics rather than Newtonian mechanics as her example.

Q73. [Hard]

Sociologist Mei Taniguchi studied how the transition from in-person to remote work during a global health crisis affected knowledge sharing among employees at a large consulting firm. Before the transition, junior employees frequently acquired tacit knowledge—unwritten skills and contextual understanding—through informal interactions such as overhearing senior colleagues' conversations, observing their problem-solving approaches, and receiving spontaneous feedback. After the shift to remote work, junior employees reported that their formal skills training continued uninterrupted but that they felt less confident handling ambiguous, nonroutine tasks. Senior employees, by contrast, reported no comparable decline in confidence. Taniguchi's findings suggest that

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) formal skills training is more effective than informal interaction for developing competence in nonroutine tasks. B) knowledge sharing between junior and senior employees ceased entirely during the remote work period. C) senior employees benefited more from remote work than junior employees because they preferred working independently. D) the loss of informal, in-person interaction disproportionately affects less experienced workers whose development depends heavily on the tacit knowledge transmitted through proximity to experts.

Q74. [Hard]

Volcanologist Carmen Alvarez studied lava tubes—tunnels formed when the surface of a flowing lava stream cools and solidifies while molten lava continues to flow beneath. She found that lava tubes on the flanks of Mauna Loa in Hawaii extend for distances of up to 50 kilometers, far longer than conventional thermal models predict. These models assume that heat loss through the tube walls should cause the lava to solidify within approximately 20 kilometers. Alvarez proposed that the discrepancy is explained by the insulating properties of the solidified tube walls themselves: as the walls thicken, they increasingly prevent heat from escaping, allowing the lava to maintain its fluidity over greater distances. Alvarez's proposal would be most directly supported if

Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Alvarez's proposal?

- A) lava tubes on volcanoes with lower eruption temperatures are consistently shorter than those on Mauna Loa. B) measurements of tube wall thickness along the length of Mauna Loa's longest tubes show a progressive increase in wall thickness that correlates with reduced heat loss at greater distances from the vent. C) lava tubes on Mars, where surface temperatures are much lower than on Earth, are shorter than those on Mauna Loa. D) the chemical composition of lava in Mauna Loa's tubes is identical to that of lava in shorter tubes on other Hawaiian volcanoes.
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Q75. [Hard]

The following text is adapted from a 1961 essay by cultural critic Helena Varga.

Mass literacy, which the reformers of the nineteenth century championed as the ultimate democratic tool, has revealed an irony they did not foresee. The ability to read, once rare and therefore powerful, has become universal and therefore ordinary. What was once a gateway to independent thought is now just as often a gateway to passive consumption: the same skill that enables a citizen to read a political treatise enables her to absorb, without resistance, the language of an advertisement. The reformers were right that literacy would reshape society; they were wrong about the direction.

As presented in the text, Varga would most likely agree with which statement?

- A) The spread of literacy has had complex consequences, empowering critical engagement for some while also enabling unreflective consumption for others. B) Mass literacy has failed to produce any of the democratic benefits that nineteenth-century reformers anticipated. C) Advertisements are the most influential form of written communication in modern democratic societies. D) Nineteenth-century reformers would have opposed mass literacy if they had foreseen its consequences.
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Q76. [Hard]

Oceanographer Tariq Hassan used autonomous underwater vehicles to map hydrothermal vent fields along the Mid-Atlantic Ridge. He discovered that vent fields separated by distances of less than 500 meters often harbored species communities with less than 30 percent overlap, while fields separated by 5 kilometers or more sometimes shared over 70 percent of their species. This counterintuitive pattern contradicts the expectation that geographic proximity should predict community similarity. Hassan proposed that the chemical composition of the vent fluid—which varies based on the underlying rock type—exerts a stronger influence on species community composition than geographic distance does. Hassan's proposal implies that ____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) hydrothermal vent communities are determined primarily by the chemical environment rather than by the organisms' ability to disperse between nearby sites. B) all hydrothermal vent fields along the Mid-Atlantic Ridge share identical species communities. C) geographic distance is the only factor that determines species community composition in marine ecosystems. D) hydrothermal vent organisms are unable to survive in vent fluids with different chemical compositions from those of their native vent.
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Q77. [Hard]

Text 1 Education researcher Pavel Novak advocates for the integration of competitive academic contests, such as math olympiads and debate tournaments, into the standard school curriculum. Novak argues that competition motivates students to pursue deeper mastery of subjects and teaches resilience in the face of setbacks. He points to research showing that students who participate in academic competitions score higher on standardized assessments and are more likely to pursue advanced degrees.

Text 2 Education researcher Fiona Campbell warns that the research Novak cites suffers from selection bias: students who voluntarily enter academic competitions tend to be higher-achieving and more motivated to begin with, making it difficult to attribute their success to the competitive experience itself. Campbell further argues

that embedding competition in the standard curriculum—rather than offering it as an optional enrichment activity—could discourage students who respond poorly to competitive pressure, particularly those from backgrounds where academic risk-taking is less culturally supported.

Based on the texts, how would Campbell most likely respond to Novak's claim that competition motivates deeper mastery?

A) By conceding that competition reliably produces deeper mastery for all students. B) By asserting that standardized assessments are not valid measures of academic mastery. C) By arguing that the evidence for competition's motivational benefits is confounded by self-selection and that mandating competition could harm the students it is least likely to help. D) By suggesting that academic competitions should be replaced entirely with collaborative learning activities.

Q78. [Hard]

Astrophysicist Renata Kuznetsova studied fast radio bursts (FRBs)—intense, millisecond-duration pulses of radio waves originating from outside our galaxy. Most FRBs are one-time events, but a small subset repeat at irregular intervals. Kuznetsova analyzed the timing patterns of a repeating FRB source and found that its bursts occurred in clusters separated by periods of silence lasting 40 to 60 days. She proposed that the source is a highly magnetized neutron star orbiting a companion object, and that bursts occur only when the neutron star passes through a cloud of plasma surrounding the companion. During the periods of silence, the neutron star would be outside the plasma cloud and unable to generate the interaction that produces the bursts. Kuznetsova's model predicts that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the interval between burst clusters should be roughly periodic, corresponding to the neutron star's orbital period around its companion. B) all fast radio bursts, including non-repeating ones, originate from binary star systems. C) the frequency of bursts within each cluster should increase over time as the neutron star's orbit decays. D) the plasma cloud surrounding the companion object should emit visible light detectable by optical telescopes.

Q79. [Hard]

Behavioral economist Lena Brandt investigated how the framing of charitable appeals affects donation behavior. She presented 1,200 participants with an appeal for a disaster relief organization. Half the participants received a version emphasizing a single identifiable victim (a named child with a photograph and personal story), while the other half received a version presenting statistical information about the scope of the disaster (number of displaced families, total economic losses). Consistent with prior research on the "identifiable victim effect," participants who received the individual story donated an average of \$28, compared with \$16 for those who received the statistical version. However, Brandt added a third condition in which participants received both the individual story and the statistics. Surprisingly, donations in this combined condition averaged only \$19—significantly lower than the story-only condition. Brandt proposed that the addition of statistics activates a more analytical mode of thinking that partially suppresses the emotional response evoked by the individual story. Brandt's proposal implies that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) statistical information about disasters is always less persuasive than individual victim narratives. B) charitable organizations seeking to maximize donations should avoid combining emotional narratives with statistical information in the same appeal. C) donors who give in response to individual victim stories are irrational and their behavior should be corrected. D) the identifiable victim effect operates only when the victim is a child rather than an adult.

Q80. [Hard]

Historian Amara Kessler examined the economic effects of the 1854 Reciprocity Treaty between British North

America and the United States, which eliminated tariffs on natural resources traded between the two regions. Previous historians had attributed the sharp increase in cross-border trade following the treaty primarily to the tariff reduction itself. Kessler, however, found that trade volumes had already been rising substantially in the years immediately before the treaty was signed, driven by the expansion of railroad networks that connected interior resource-producing regions to ports and border crossings. The treaty's tariff reduction, Kessler argued, amplified an existing trend but was not its primary initiator. By comparing the rate of trade growth before and after 1854, Kessler showed that the post-treaty acceleration, while real, was only modestly greater than what the pre-treaty trend line would have predicted. Kessler's analysis suggests that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A) the Reciprocity Treaty had no measurable effect on trade between British North America and the United States. B) improvements in transportation infrastructure may have been a more fundamental driver of trade growth than the tariff reduction, which added incremental rather than transformative impetus. C) railroad expansion in the 1850s was itself a consequence of the Reciprocity Treaty's tariff reductions. D) tariff reductions are always less effective at stimulating trade than investments in transportation infrastructure.

END OF DOC 1 — QUESTIONS